prime minister, both nationally and internationally. It is not an accident that the BJP made much of the establishment of the International Yoga Day by the UN on 14 December 2014. The UN Resolution was proposed by Prime Minister Modi himself in an address during the opening of the 69th session of the General Assembly. 'Yoga is an invaluable gift from our ancient tradition,' he told the UN. 'Yoga embodies unity of mind and body, thought and action … a holistic approach … Yoga is not just about exercise; it is a way to discover the sense of oneness with yourself, the world and the nature.'[18] The idea of Hindu cultural power is an incipient concept still, but what these statements indicate is a visualisation of India as a Hindu power (probably like Israel is a Jewish power) without territorial aspirations.

Such a projection, using civilisational markers, also seems explicitly linked now to India's long-held aspiration as a rising power for a bigger seat in global forums, such as its bid for a permanent seat on the UN Security Council.[19] For the purveyors of 'New India'—a slogan formally adopted by the BJP in a political resolution on 9 September 2018[20]—the signs from Ayodhya indicated that such a country would overwhelmingly look to its Hindu traditions as markers of identity. It may not become a Hindu democracy constitutionally (unlike, say, Israel's Jewish democracy), it may not initiate military conscription for all, it may not look to grab land from its neighbours and Muslims may not become de jure second-class citizens (unlike Arabs in Israel), but the ambition to visibly demonstrate Hindu power is clear. The desire to be acknowledged globally is precisely why a billboard displaying the Ram Temple on bhoomi-pujan day at New York's Times Square was important for the BJP and its supporters.[21] It is another matter that its advertising coincided with pro-Kashmir and anti-Indian state advertising on the same billboards.

The BJP is deeply invested in the notion of correcting what it sees as past wrongs, an impulse that is intrinsically linked to the desire to rewrite history from 'India's point of view', as Amit Shah advised historians at Banaras Hindu University to do in late 2019. 'Putting together our history, improving our history and rewriting our history again is the responsibility of the country, the people and the